

# GTU Exam Questions - Solved

Digital Marketing (DI03016011) - GTU Diploma IT Sem 3  
Winter 2025 + Summer 2026 papers

**What this PDF is:** every question from the two GTU papers for this new subject (Winter 2025 and Summer 2026), solved in exam-ready form. Each paper is **70 marks**: 5 questions, each with (a) 3 marks, (b) 4 marks, (c) 7 marks, and an **OR** alternative for each part. This is an **application-type paper** - many questions ask you to 'develop a strategy' or 'explain with example', so always add a small real example.

## PRIORITY 1: Topics that came in BOTH papers (study first)

With only two papers, a topic in both is the safest bet. It is not a guarantee - read the rest too.

| Topic                                    | Winter 2025                              | Summer 2026                  |
|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Latest trends / basics</b>            | Q1(a) (3M), Q2(a) (3M)                   | Q1(c) OR (7M)                |
| <b>Traditional vs Digital</b>            | Q1(b) (4M)                               | Q1(a) (3M)                   |
| <b>SEO strategy / off-page</b>           | Q1(c) (7M), Q1(c) OR (7M), Q2(c) OR (7M) | Q2(c) (7M)                   |
| <b>White vs Black hat</b>                | Q2(b) (4M)                               | Q3(b) (4M)                   |
| <b>How search engines work</b>           | Q2(c) (7M)                               | Q2(b) OR (4M)                |
| <b>Digital marketing strategy / POEM</b> | Q2(a) OR (3M)                            | Q1(c) (7M)                   |
| <b>Web metrics</b>                       | Q3(a) (3M), Q3(a) OR (3M)                | Q3(a) OR (3M)                |
| <b>Data collection methods</b>           | Q3(b) (4M)                               | Q4(b) OR (4M)                |
| <b>A/B and multivariate testing</b>      | Q3(c) (7M)                               | Q3(c) (7M)                   |
| <b>Google Tag Manager</b>                | Q3(b) OR (4M)                            | Q4(a) OR (3M)                |
| <b>Attribution models</b>                | Q3(c) OR (7M)                            | Q3(a) (3M)                   |
| <b>Conversion and goals</b>              | Q4(a) (3M)                               | Q3(c) OR (7M)                |
| <b>Meta ads and Insights</b>             | Q4(b) (4M)                               | Q4(b) (4M), Q4(c) OR (7M)    |
| <b>Twitter (X) marketing</b>             | Q4(a) OR (3M)                            | Q5(b) (4M)                   |
| <b>Social media strategy</b>             | Q4(c) OR (7M)                            | Q5(b) OR (4M)                |
| <b>Email marketing</b>                   | Q5(a) (3M), Q5(b) (4M)                   | Q5(a) (3M)                   |
| <b>SEM concepts and ads</b>              | Q5(c) (7M), Q5(a) OR (3M), Q5(b) OR (4M) | Q5(a) OR (3M), Q5(c) OR (7M) |
| <b>Ad extensions</b>                     | Q5(c) OR (7M)                            | Q5(c) (7M)                   |

## PRIORITY 2: Asked once (also important)

- Analyze how mobile-friendliness and page speed influence SEO ranking - W2025 Q2(b) OR

- Choose any brand and describe how it can use video marketing to promote a new pr - W2025 Q4(c)
- In what ways does video content enhance engagement on social platforms - W2025 Q4(b) OR
- Explain the importance of data privacy in the context of digital marketing - S2026 Q1(b)
- Describe the need of SEO in digital marketing - S2026 Q2(a)
- Differentiate between on-page and off-page SEO - S2026 Q2(b)
- Express the role of social media in digital marketing - S2026 Q2(a) OR
- How can social media improve SEO rankings - S2026 Q2(c) OR
- Describe the strategies for building backlinks - S2026 Q3(b) OR
- Define Analytics and list out SEO analytics tools - S2026 Q4(a)
- Explain the concept of Dynamic Ads and give an example of how they can be person - S2026 Q4(c)

### Unit-wise marks pattern (syllabus weightage)

| Unit                                | Weightage | Expected marks out of 70 |
|-------------------------------------|-----------|--------------------------|
| 1 Introduction to Digital Marketing | 20%       | ≈ 14                     |
| 2 SEO                               | 24%       | ≈ 17                     |
| 3 Web Analytics                     | 22%       | ≈ 15                     |
| 4 Social Media Marketing            | 18%       | ≈ 13                     |
| 5 Email Marketing and SEM           | 16%       | ≈ 11                     |

## Solved paper - Winter 2025 (04-12-2025)

**Q1(a) [3 marks] What is digital marketing? List any two current trends in digital marketing.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q1(c) OR (7M)

- **Digital marketing** is the promotion of products, services or brands using **digital channels** such as the internet, search engines, social media, email, websites and mobile apps, to reach and engage customers online.
- **Scope:** SEO, SEM / paid ads, social media marketing, email marketing, content marketing, video marketing, affiliate and influencer marketing, mobile marketing and web analytics.
- **Significance:** wide (global) reach, low cost, precise targeting, 24x7 presence, two-way communication and **measurable results** (clicks, conversions).

**Two current trends (write any two)**

- **AI-powered marketing** - chatbots, personalised recommendations and automated campaigns (e.g. Amazon 'recommended for you').
- **Short-form video** - Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, TikTok-style videos get very high engagement.
- Voice search and conversational AI (Alexa, Siri); Metaverse / AR-VR experiences; zero-click searches.

**Q1(b) [4 marks] How does digital marketing differ from traditional marketing in terms of approach and customer engagement?**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q1(a) (3M)

| Point                      | Traditional marketing                          | Digital marketing                                      |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Medium                     | TV, radio, newspaper, hoardings, pamphlets     | Internet: websites, search, social media, email, apps  |
| <b>Approach</b>            | One-way broadcast - same message to everybody  | Targeted and personalised message to a chosen audience |
| <b>Customer engagement</b> | Little or no direct response; feedback is slow | Two-way: likes, comments, shares, chats, instant reply |
| Cost                       | High (ad space, printing, airtime)             | Lower; start with a small budget                       |
| Reach                      | Local / limited by geography                   | Global, 24x7                                           |
| Measurement                | Difficult and slow (guess-work)                | Real-time and exact (clicks, conversions, ROI)         |
| Flexibility                | Cannot change once printed or aired            | Can edit or pause a campaign any time                  |
| Example                    | Newspaper ad of a shop                         | Instagram ad targeted to people near the shop          |

**Exam tip:** For 3 marks write the first five rows. For the 4-mark 'approach and engagement' question, explain the two bold rows in 2 lines each, then add cost and measurement.

**Q1(c) [7 marks] Develop a short SEO strategy for a local shoe repair business, with at least three on-page and three off-page tactics.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q2(c) (7M)

**Goal:** appear in the top results when people near the shop search 'shoe repair near me' and bring walk-ins and calls.

**Step 1: Keyword research**

Use Google Keyword Planner / Ubersuggest. Target local, long-tail keywords: *shoe repair near me*, *sole repair [city]*, *leather shoe polish and repair*, *bag zip repair*.

### Step 2: On-page tactics (at least three)

1. **Title tag and meta description** with keyword + city, e.g. 'Shoe Repair in [City] | Quick Sole and Leather Repair'.
2. **Service pages and headings** (H1, H2): separate page for sole repair, stitching, polishing, with local keywords and prices.
3. **Image alt text and quality photos** of before / after repairs; fast, mobile-friendly pages.
4. **LocalBusiness schema** with name, address, phone (NAP) and opening hours; a clear call button.

### Step 3: Off-page tactics (at least three)

1. **Google Business Profile:** claim and complete it (address, timings, photos). Most important for local SEO.
2. **Customer reviews:** ask happy customers to review on Google and reply to each.
3. **Local directories / citations** (Justdial, Sulekha, Google Maps) with the **same NAP** everywhere.
4. **Local backlinks:** links from local blogs, colleges, shoe shops and community pages.
5. **Social media** pages with before / after posts and local hashtags.

### Step 4: Measure

Track calls, direction requests, rankings for 'shoe repair near me', and website visits in Google Search Console and Analytics.

**Q1(c) OR [7 marks] A new local bakery 'Sweet Delights' has a website. Recommend a keyword strategy and create one Meta Description and Title Tag for the 'Custom Cakes' page.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q2(c) (7M)

### Keyword strategy

1. **Seed keywords:** custom cakes, designer cakes, birthday cakes, wedding cakes.
2. **Long-tail and local keywords** (easier to rank, buying intent): 'custom birthday cake in [city]', 'eggless custom cake near me', 'photo cake delivery', 'theme cake for kids'.
3. **Search intent:** informational (cake design ideas), commercial ('best custom cake shop'), transactional ('order custom cake online'). The Custom Cakes page targets **transactional** keywords.
4. **Tools:** Google Keyword Planner, Ubersuggest; check search volume, competition and what competitors use.
5. **Placement:** main keyword in title tag, H1, first 100 words, URL (/custom-cakes), image alt text; related keywords in sub-headings. No keyword stuffing.
6. Use separate blog pages for informational keywords and link them to the Custom Cakes page.

### Title tag (max 60 characters)

**Custom Cakes Near You | Sweet Delights Bakery** (45 characters)

### Meta description (max 160 characters)

**Order fresh, eggless and designer custom cakes for birthdays and weddings from Sweet Delights. Choose flavour, size and design online. Order today!** (147 characters)

Both contain the main keyword, are unique, and end with a call to action. Replace 'Near You' with the city name for local ranking.

**Q2(a) [3 marks] Define Zero-click searches. Why are they significant in SEO?**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q1(c) OR (7M)

**Zero-click search:** a search where the user gets the answer **directly on the search results page** (featured snippet, knowledge panel, weather, calculator, map pack) and **does not click** any website.

### Significance in SEO

- Organic **click-through rate and website traffic fall**, even if the page ranks well.
- Brand gets **visibility and authority** if its content is shown in the featured snippet (position zero).
- SEO must now optimise for **snippets**: short direct answers, headings as questions, FAQ and schema markup.
- Success is measured by **impressions and brand searches**, not only clicks.

**Q2(b) [4 marks] Differentiate between White Hat and Black Hat SEO with a relevant example for each.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q3(b) (4M)

| Point      | White Hat SEO                                                                                                              | Black Hat SEO                                                                                            |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Meaning    | Ethical techniques that follow search-engine guidelines                                                                    | Unethical tricks that try to fool search engines for fast ranking                                        |
| Focus      | Real users and quality content                                                                                             | Only search-engine algorithm                                                                             |
| Techniques | Quality content, proper keyword research, good titles and meta tags, mobile-friendly site, genuine backlinks, fast loading | Keyword stuffing, cloaking, hidden text, link farms / buying links, doorway pages, copied / spun content |
| Result     | Slow but long-term, stable ranking                                                                                         | Quick gain but short-lived                                                                               |
| Risk       | Very low                                                                                                                   | Penalty or complete removal (ban) from search results                                                    |
| Example    | A travel blog writes original guides and gets links from other travel sites                                                | A site repeats 'cheap shoes cheap shoes cheap shoes' 100 times or hides white text on a white background |

Grey hat SEO lies in between (not clearly breaking rules).

**Q2(c) [7 marks] Explain how search engines work. Discuss the key factors that influence how content is ranked.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q2(b) OR (4M)



- Crawling:** automated programs called **crawlers / spiders / bots** (Googlebot) travel from link to link and discover new or updated pages. A **sitemap.xml** helps them; **robots.txt** tells them what not to crawl.
- Indexing:** the content of each page (text, images, titles, links) is analysed and saved in a huge database called the **index**.
- Ranking:** when a user searches, the **algorithm** picks relevant pages from the index and orders them using hundreds of signals. Best results are shown first on the **SERP** (search engine results page).

### Key factors that influence ranking

| Factor                        | Why it matters                                                              |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Content quality and relevance | Useful, original content that matches the user's search intent ranks higher |
| Keywords                      | Right keywords in title, headings and body show what the page is about      |
| Backlinks                     | Links from trusted sites act as 'votes' of trust (authority)                |
| Mobile-friendliness           | Google uses mobile-first indexing                                           |
| Page speed                    | Slow pages lose visitors and rank lower                                     |
| HTTPS security                | Secure sites are preferred                                                  |
| User experience               | Low bounce rate, easy navigation, longer time on site                       |
| Freshness and structured data | Regularly updated pages; schema helps rich results                          |
| Location and personalisation  | Results change by user's location and search history                        |

**Exam tip:** 4 marks: write the 4-step flow with 1 line each and 4-5 factors. 7 marks: full answer with the table.

## Q2(a) OR [3 marks] Explain the P.O.E.M. framework with suitable examples of each component.

★ **Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q1(c) (7M)**

*How much to write: Write meaning of P.O.E.M. and the three media with examples.*

**P.O.E.M. = Paid, Owned, Earned Media** - the three types of media a brand uses in its digital marketing strategy.

**PAID media**  
(you pay)

**OWNED media**  
(you control)

**EARNED media**  
(others give you)

| Media         | Meaning                                                   | Examples                                                                                    |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Paid</b>   | Space or reach you <b>pay for</b>                         | Google Ads, Instagram / Facebook ads, sponsored posts, influencer promotion                 |
| <b>Owned</b>  | Channels the brand <b>owns and controls</b>               | Website, blog, mobile app, email list, YouTube channel, social media pages                  |
| <b>Earned</b> | Publicity <b>gained for free</b> through audience / media | Customer reviews, shares and mentions, word of mouth, news coverage, user-generated content |

*Example - Nike:* paid = YouTube ads; owned = nike.com and Nike app; earned = fans sharing photos with its shoes and media talking about a campaign.

## Q2(b) OR [4 marks] Analyze how mobile-friendliness and page speed influence SEO ranking.

- **Mobile-friendliness:** most searches are on phones and Google uses **mobile-first indexing** (the mobile version of the page is used for ranking). A non-responsive site with tiny text and hard-to-tap buttons gives a poor experience and ranks lower.
- **Page speed:** speed is a ranking signal and part of **Core Web Vitals** (loading, interactivity, visual stability). A slow site increases the **bounce rate**, lowers time on site and conversions, which tells Google the page is not useful.
- **How to improve:** responsive design, compress images, enable caching / CDN, minify CSS and JavaScript, use a good host. Test with Google PageSpeed Insights, GTmetrix.

**Example:** If an online shop takes 7 seconds to load on mobile, most visitors leave; after compressing images and using responsive design it loads in 2 seconds, so traffic and ranking improve.

**Q2(c) OR [7 marks] You have a newly launched blog. Outline the steps to improve its SEO ranking organically (without paid ads).**

★ **Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q2(c) (7M)**

1. **Keyword research** - find topics people search for (Google Keyword Planner, Ubersuggest); prefer long-tail low-competition keywords.
  2. **Create high-quality, original content** that answers the user's question; write regularly.
  3. **On-page SEO** - keyword in title (under 60 chars), meta description (under 160), headings, URL, image alt text; short readable paragraphs.
  4. **Internal linking** between related posts.
  5. **Technical SEO** - mobile-friendly theme, fast loading, HTTPS, sitemap.xml; submit the blog in **Google Search Console**.
  6. **Build backlinks** - guest posts, share in communities, ethical outreach, link-worthy content (infographics).
  7. **Promote on social media** to get traffic and shares.
  8. **Update old posts**, fix broken links, improve slow pages.
  9. **Track** traffic, bounce rate and rankings in Analytics / Search Console and keep improving.
- Use only organic (free, white-hat) methods - no paid ads, no buying links.

**Q3(a) [3 marks] Define and explain the metric Unique Visitors.**

★ **Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q3(a) OR (3M)**

- **Unique visitors:** the number of **different individual people (or devices)** who visit a website in a given period. Each person is counted **only once**, even if he visits 10 times (identified by cookie / device ID).
- **Why it matters:** shows the real size of the audience and reach of the site, unlike total visits.

*Example:* Ravi visits your site 5 times and Meena 2 times in a week → **visits = 7, unique visitors = 2**.

**Pageviews** (related): total number of pages viewed; one page opened again is counted again.

**Q3(b) [4 marks] Differentiate between weblogs and page tagging as methods of data collection.**

★ **Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q4(b) OR (4M)**

Two main methods are used to collect website visitor data:

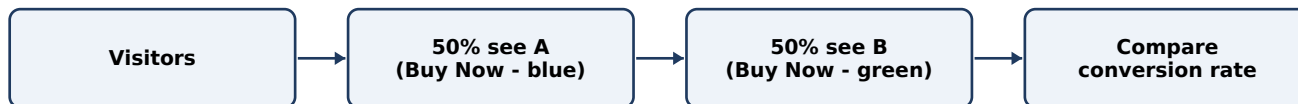
| Point         | Weblogs (server log files)                                                                                                | Page tagging (JavaScript tags)                                                                                         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| How it works  | Web server automatically records <b>every request</b> in a log file (IP, date/time, page, status code, browser, referrer) | A small <b>JavaScript code (tag)</b> on each page runs in the visitor's browser and sends data to the analytics server |
| Data location | On your own server                                                                                                        | On the analytics vendor's server (e.g. Google Analytics)                                                               |
| Setup         | No code needed on pages; needs log analyser software                                                                      | Add tag to every page (or use Google Tag Manager)                                                                      |
| Tracks        | Page requests, bots and crawlers, errors (404)                                                                            | User behaviour: clicks, scrolls, events, time on page, device, real-time                                               |
| Limitations   | Cannot track JavaScript events; cached pages and bots confuse counts; hard to identify unique visitors                    | Fails if JavaScript is disabled or blocked (ad-blockers); depends on third party                                       |
| Example       | Apache / IIS log analysis                                                                                                 | Google Analytics, Matomo                                                                                               |

Other methods: cookies (identify returning visitors), packet sniffing, and in-app SDKs for mobile apps.

### Q3(c) [7 marks] Explain A/B testing. How does it differ from multivariate testing in web optimization?

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q3(c) (7M)

- **A/B testing (split testing):** two versions of a page / element - **A (control)** and **B (variation)** - are shown to **different random groups** of visitors at the same time. The version with the better result (more clicks, sign-ups, sales) wins. Only **one element** is changed (e.g. button colour or headline).
- **Multivariate testing (MVT):** tests **several elements together** and all their **combinations** to find the best combination.



| Point             | A/B testing                         | Multivariate testing                                  |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| What is tested    | One variable, two (or few) versions | Multiple variables and their combinations             |
| Example           | Headline 1 vs Headline 2            | 2 headlines × 2 images × 2 buttons = 8 combinations   |
| Traffic needed    | Less                                | Much more (traffic is divided among all combinations) |
| Time / complexity | Simple and fast                     | Complex, longer                                       |
| Result            | Which version is better             | Which combination, and how elements interact          |
| Best for          | Big changes, low-traffic sites      | Fine-tuning high-traffic pages                        |

### Testing tools and their role in optimising website performance

- **Tools:** Optimizely, VWO (Visual Website Optimizer), AB Tasty, Adobe Target, Convert (Google Optimize was shut down in 2023).
- **Role:** split traffic randomly, show variations, track goals, calculate **statistical significance** and show the winner.
- **Benefits:** increases **conversion rate**, decisions based on data not guesses, lowers risk of bad changes, improves user experience and ROI.

### Q3(a) OR [3 marks] Define and explain the metrics: Pages/Visit and New Visits.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q3(a) OR (3M)

- **Pages/Visit** (pages per session): the **average number of pages** a visitor views in one visit. Higher value = visitors are interested and exploring.

**Formula:** Pages/Visit = Total pageviews ÷ Total visits. Example: 5,000 pageviews ÷ 2,000 visits = 2.5.

- **New Visits** (% new visits): the **percentage of visits made by first-time visitors**. Shows how well the site attracts new audience; the rest are returning visitors (loyalty).

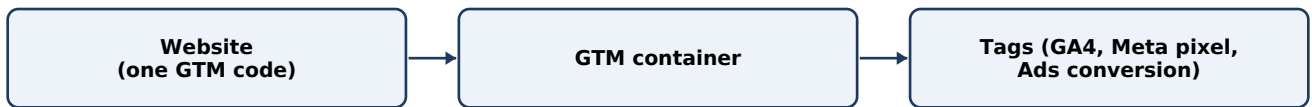
**Formula:** % New visits = (Visits from new visitors ÷ Total visits) × 100. Example: 600 of 1,000 visits are new → **60%**.

### Q3(b) OR [4 marks] What is Google Tag Manager? How does it simplify the analytics setup process?

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q4(a) OR (3M)

**Google Tag Manager (GTM)** is a **free tag-management system** by Google. You place **one GTM container code** on the website, and then add, edit and manage all **tags** (small tracking code snippets such as Google Analytics, Meta pixel, conversion tracking) from a web dashboard

without changing the website code each time.



### Main parts

- **Tag:** code that sends data to a tool.
- **Trigger:** the rule when the tag fires (page view, button click, form submit).
- **Variable:** values used by tags / triggers (page URL, click text).

### Tasks of GTM / how it simplifies analytics setup

- Add and update tracking tags **without a developer**.
- Track clicks, form submissions, scroll, video views, downloads (event tracking).
- Manage many tags in **one place** - faster page loading than many separate scripts.
- **Preview / debug mode** to test before publishing, with **version control** and rollback.
- Set up conversion tracking for ads and remarketing.

### Q3(c) OR [7 marks] Compare the Linear and Time-Decay multi-touch attribution models with suitable examples for each.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q3(a) (3M)

**Multi-touch attribution** shares the credit for a conversion among **several touchpoints** in the customer journey.

**Customer journey example:** sale of ₹1,000 with 4 touchpoints in order: ① **Instagram ad** → ② **Blog post (Google search)** → ③ **Email** → ④ **Search ad click** → **Purchase**



### Linear model

Gives **equal credit** to every touchpoint. Each gets 25% = **₹250**. Good for long journeys where every step helps; ignores that some touches matter more.

### Time-decay model

Gives **more credit to touchpoints closer to the conversion**, less to older ones. Example split: 10% / 20% / 30% / 40% = **₹100, ₹200, ₹300, ₹400**. Good for short sales cycles or promotions.

| Point            | Linear                        | Time-decay                              |
|------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Credit           | Equal to all touchpoints      | More to recent touchpoints              |
| Example (₹1,000) | ₹250 each                     | ₹100 / ₹200 / ₹300 / ₹400               |
| Best for         | Long journeys; brand building | Short campaigns, flash sales            |
| Drawback         | Treats all touches as same    | Undervalues the first (awareness) touch |

Other multi-touch models: position-based (U-shaped), data-driven. Note: newer GA4 versions offer mainly data-driven and last-click models; the syllabus models are still asked in theory.

### Q4(a) [3 marks] Define the term 'conversion rate'. Why is it an important metric in web analytics?

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q3(c) OR (7M)

**Conversion rate** is the percentage of visitors who complete a **desired action (goal)** such as a purchase, sign-up, form submission or download.

**Formula:** Conversion rate = (Number of conversions ÷ Number of visitors) × 100. Example: 50 sales from 2,000 visitors = **2.5%**.

### Why it is important

- Shows how **effective** the website / campaign is in turning visitors into customers.
- Helps find weak pages and improve them (A/B testing).
- Lets you compare channels and calculate **ROI**; improves profit without extra traffic cost.

### Q4(b) [4 marks] List the different types of Meta (Facebook/Instagram) ads and briefly describe two of their use cases.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q4(b) (4M), Q4(c) OR (7M)

**Meta** (Facebook, Instagram, Messenger) offers these ad types (syllabus):

| Ad type                    | What it is                                                                    | Use case                                                                   |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Carousel ads</b>        | 2-10 scrollable images / videos, each with its own link                       | Fashion store shows 5 dresses in one ad; real-estate shows different flats |
| <b>Story ads</b>           | Full-screen vertical (9:16) ads between Facebook / Instagram Stories          | Flash sale or festival offer with 'Swipe up / Shop now'                    |
| <b>Lead generation ads</b> | Ad with an in-app form to collect name, email, phone without leaving Facebook | Coaching class collects enquiries; free demo or newsletter sign-up         |
| <b>Video ads</b>           | Video in feed, stories or Reels                                               | Product demo or brand story to raise awareness                             |

Others: image ads, collection ads, dynamic (catalogue) ads. Ads are created in **Meta Ads Manager**.

### Q4(c) [7 marks] Choose any brand and describe how it can use video marketing to promote a new product/service, outlining at least two specific video formats.

*How much to write: Write the Nike example with at least two video formats, and the plan.*

| Video type        | Purpose                                                             |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Explainer video   | Short video explaining a product or idea simply                     |
| Educational video | Teaches something (how-to, tutorials)                               |
| Animation video   | Animated visuals for complex or abstract topics                     |
| Brand video       | Tells the brand story, values                                       |
| Testimonial video | Real customers share their experience - builds trust                |
| Demo video        | Shows how the product works                                         |
| 360° video        | Viewer looks around in all directions (tours, real estate, travel)  |
| AR video          | Augmented reality - e.g. virtual try-on, see furniture in your room |

### Best practices in video marketing

- Hook the viewer in the **first 3-5 seconds**; keep it short.
- Add **subtitles** (many watch without sound); mobile-first / vertical format.
- Clear **call to action** and branding; good audio and quality.
- Optimise title, description, tags and thumbnail for search.
- Post consistently and **measure** views, watch time, engagement.

**Brand chosen:** Nike - launching a new running shoe 'AirRun X'.

**Objective:** create awareness before launch and generate sales after launch.

| Video format                                        | Platform                      | Idea                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Teaser / short-form video (Reels, Shorts)</b> | Instagram, YouTube Shorts     | 15-30 second teasers showing the shoe in motion with a countdown and hashtag #RunWithAirRunX; hook in first 3 seconds |
| <b>2. Product demo video</b>                        | YouTube, website product page | Shows cushioning, grip and weight, tested by runners; ends with 'Buy now' link                                        |
| <b>3. Testimonial video</b>                         | Facebook, Instagram           | Athletes and regular runners share their experience                                                                   |
| <b>4. 360° / AR video</b>                           | Website, app                  | Customer rotates the shoe in 360° or tries it virtually                                                               |

### Plan

1. Pre-launch teasers → launch demo and brand film → post-launch testimonials and user videos.
2. Share on YouTube, Instagram, Facebook; run **video ads** to a targeted audience (runners, age 18-35).
3. Add subtitles, clear CTA and link to buy.
4. Track views, watch time, CTR and sales; improve next videos.

### Q4(a) OR [3 marks] What are promoted tweets, promoted accounts, and promoted trends on Twitter?

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q5(b) (4M)

- **Promoted tweets:** ordinary tweets that a brand **pays** to show to a wider / targeted audience in timelines and search results; labelled 'Promoted'. Aim: reach, clicks, engagement.
- **Promoted accounts:** the brand's account is suggested in 'Who to follow' and timelines to gain **more followers**.
- **Promoted trends:** a brand's **hashtag / topic is placed at the top of the Trending list** for a day, giving massive visibility (used for big launches).

### Q4(b) OR [4 marks] In what ways does video content enhance engagement on social platforms?

1. **Grabs attention** quickly with moving visuals and sound - more eye-catching than text.
2. **Higher likes, comments and shares;** people share entertaining or useful videos.
3. **Conveys message faster** and is remembered longer; shows emotion and personality.
4. **Platform algorithms favour video** (Reels, Shorts), giving more reach.
5. **Interactive formats** - live videos, polls, Q&A - allow real-time conversation.
6. **Longer time spent** and builds trust (testimonials, demos), leading to more conversions.

### Q4(c) OR [7 marks] Imagine you are launching a sustainable clothing line. Develop a social media marketing strategy outline including platform choice and specific content ideas.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q5(b) OR (4M)

**Business:** 'EcoThread' - sustainable clothing made from organic cotton and recycled fabric.

**Target audience:** eco-conscious students and young professionals, age 18-35.

#### 1. Goals

Brand awareness, 5,000 followers and 100 online orders in 3 months.

#### 2. Platform choice

| Platform                                     | Why                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Instagram</b> (Reels, Stories, carousels) | Main platform for fashion and young audience; visual shopping |
| <b>YouTube / Shorts</b>                      | Behind-the-scenes, fabric-making and styling videos           |
| <b>Pinterest</b>                             | Outfit inspiration, drives website traffic                    |
| <b>Facebook and LinkedIn</b>                 | Community and ads; LinkedIn for corporate / uniform orders    |

### 3. Content ideas

- **Behind-the-scenes** of organic cotton farming and factory.
- **Reels:** 'How a T-shirt is made from plastic bottles', 30-wear challenge, styling one shirt 5 ways.
- **Carousel / infographics:** 'Water saved by one organic shirt'.
- **User-generated content** with #WearTheChange; customer testimonial videos.
- Influencer collaborations with eco-lifestyle creators; polls, quizzes, Q&A, giveaways.

### 4. Engagement tactics and ads

- Reply to every comment / DM; weekly live Q&A.
- Run Meta carousel and lead ads to the target group; retarget website visitors.
- Offer first-order discount to followers.

### 5. Measure

Instagram Insights (reach, engagement, saves), website clicks, conversions and cost per order; improve monthly.

## Q5(a) [3 marks] Differentiate between promotional and transactional emails with an example of each.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q5(a) (3M)

**Email marketing:** sending commercial messages (offers, news, updates) by email to a list of subscribers to promote products, build relationships and increase sales. It is cheap, direct, personal and measurable.

### Types of marketing emails

- **Promotional emails** - offers, discounts, sales, new-product launches.
- **Transactional emails** - triggered by a user action: order confirmation, invoice, shipping update, password reset.
- **Newsletter / informational** - regular updates, tips, blog posts.
- **Welcome emails** - sent after sign-up.
- **Abandoned-cart emails** - remind about items left in cart.
- **Re-engagement / feedback / seasonal** emails.

| Point      | Promotional email                                         | Transactional email                                    |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Purpose    | To sell / promote                                         | To give information about a user's action              |
| Trigger    | Sent by the company to many people (campaign)             | Automatic, after the user's action                     |
| Permission | Needs subscriber's consent (opt-in); has unsubscribe link | Sent even without marketing opt-in                     |
| Open rate  | Lower                                                     | Very high (people expect it)                           |
| Example    | 'Flat 20% off on cakes this weekend'                      | 'Your order #1234 is confirmed' / OTP / password reset |

**Q5(b) [4 marks] What metrics are used to measure the success of email campaigns?**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q5(a) (3M)

| Metric                          | Meaning                                                                                         | Formula                                                |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Delivery rate</b>            | % of emails that reached inboxes                                                                | $\text{Delivered} \div \text{Sent} \times 100$         |
| <b>Bounce rate</b>              | % of emails not delivered (hard bounce: invalid address; soft bounce: full inbox / server down) | $\text{Bounced} \div \text{Sent} \times 100$           |
| <b>Open rate</b>                | % of delivered emails opened - shows subject-line success                                       | $\text{Opened} \div \text{Delivered} \times 100$       |
| <b>Click-through rate (CTR)</b> | % who clicked a link - shows content / CTA success                                              | $\text{Clicks} \div \text{Delivered} \times 100$       |
| <b>Unsubscribe rate</b>         | % who opted out - shows list / content problems                                                 | $\text{Unsubscribes} \div \text{Delivered} \times 100$ |
| Conversion rate                 | % who completed goal (purchase)                                                                 | $\text{Conversions} \div \text{Delivered} \times 100$  |

Example: 10,000 sent, 200 bounced → delivered 9,800 (delivery 98%, bounce 2%). 2,450 opened → open rate 25%. 490 clicked → CTR 5%. 49 unsubscribed → 0.5%.

**Q5(c) [7 marks] Create a simple SEM strategy for a local restaurant, specifying the campaign type, target keywords, and a compelling ad copy mockup.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q5(a) OR (3M), Q5(c) OR (7M)

**Business:** 'Spice Garden', a family restaurant. **Goal:** more table bookings and walk-ins within 5 km.

| Part                      | Plan                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Campaign type</b>      | <b>Search campaign</b> (people searching for food now) plus <b>Local / Location ads</b> (Google Maps listing with address and directions) |
| <b>Targeting</b>          | Radius 5 km around the restaurant; mobile devices; mainly lunch (12-3) and dinner (7-10) time                                             |
| <b>Target keywords</b>    | restaurant near me, best family restaurant in [city], Gujarati thali near me, table booking restaurant, birthday party restaurant         |
| <b>Negative keywords</b>  | free, recipe, jobs, cheap (to avoid useless clicks)                                                                                       |
| <b>Ad extensions</b>      | Call, Location, Sitelinks (Menu, Book table), Callout (Live music, Family seating)                                                        |
| <b>Budget and bidding</b> | ₹300 / day; start with 'maximise clicks', later 'maximise conversions'                                                                    |
| <b>Measure</b>            | Clicks, calls, direction requests, bookings, cost per conversion, ROAS                                                                    |

**Ad copy mockup**

**Spice Garden - Best Family Restaurant | Book a Table Now**

Ad · [www.spicegarden.example.com](http://www.spicegarden.example.com)

Authentic Gujarati and North Indian food. Cosy family seating, open till 11 PM. Book your table today and get a free dessert!

Menu · Book a Table · Live Music · Call: 98XXXXXXX · 1.2 km away

**Q5(a) OR [3 marks] Define Return on Ad Spend (ROAS) and explain how it helps in campaign decision-making.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q5(a) OR (3M), Q5(c) OR (7M)

How much to write: Write only the ROAS definition, formula, example and how it helps decisions.

**Formula: ROAS (Return on Ad Spend)** = Revenue generated from ads ÷ Cost of ads. Example: ads cost ₹5,000 and bring ₹20,000 sales → ROAS = **4** (4:1 or 400%).

### How ROAS helps in decisions

- Shows **profitability** of each campaign: ROAS above break-even = profit; below = loss.
- Helps **increase budget** on high-ROAS campaigns and **pause / improve** low ones.
- Compare channels (Search vs Display vs Social) and set bidding targets (target ROAS).

### Key SEM metrics

| Metric               | Meaning / formula                                           |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Impressions          | Number of times the ad was shown                            |
| Clicks               | Number of times the ad was clicked                          |
| CTR                  | Clicks ÷ Impressions × 100                                  |
| CPC (cost per click) | Total cost ÷ Clicks                                         |
| Conversion rate      | Conversions ÷ Clicks × 100                                  |
| Cost per conversion  | Total cost ÷ Conversions                                    |
| Quality Score        | Google's 1-10 rating of keyword / ad / landing page quality |
| ROAS                 | Revenue ÷ Ad cost                                           |
| Bounce rate          | % of visitors leaving the landing page at once              |
| Average position     | Typical rank of the ad on the page                          |

Example: 10,000 impressions, 500 clicks → CTR 5%; cost ₹5,000 → CPC ₹10; 25 conversions → conversion rate 5%, cost per conversion ₹200.

### Q5(b) OR [4 marks] Differentiate between SEO and SEM using real-world examples.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q5(a) OR (3M), Q5(c) OR (7M)

| Point          | SEO                                                           | SEM                                                                                       |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Full form      | Search Engine Optimization                                    | Search Engine Marketing (mainly paid search / PPC)                                        |
| Results        | <b>Organic</b> (free) results                                 | <b>Paid</b> ads shown at top, marked 'Ad / Sponsored'                                     |
| Cost           | No payment per click; needs time and effort                   | Pay per click (CPC) or per impression                                                     |
| Speed          | Slow (3-6 months)                                             | Instant - ads run as soon as approved                                                     |
| Traffic        | Long-lasting                                                  | Stops when you stop paying                                                                |
| Trust / clicks | Users trust organic more                                      | Users know it is an ad                                                                    |
| Example        | A blog ranks 1st for 'best study tips' due to quality content | Amazon / a travel agency bids on 'cheap flights' and its ad appears above organic results |

### Q5(c) OR [7 marks] Explain the importance of Ad Extensions in Google Ads. Describe and give an example for any three types.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Summer 2026: Q5(c) (7M)

**Ad extensions** (now also called 'assets') are **extra pieces of information** added to a Google text ad (beyond headline and description) to make it bigger and more useful. They are free to add - you pay only the normal click cost.

### Importance

- Make the ad **larger and more visible** on the results page.
- Give more information (phone, location, links) → **higher CTR** (often 10-15% more).
- Improve **Ad Rank and Quality Score**, which can lower cost per click.
- Let customers act directly (call, visit, enquire) → more conversions.

| Extension                      | What it shows                                   | Example (a restaurant / travel agency)            |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sitelink</b>                | Extra links to other pages of the site          | 'Menu', 'Book a table', 'Offers'                  |
| <b>Callout</b>                 | Short text highlighting benefits                | 'Free delivery', '24x7 support', 'No booking fee' |
| <b>Call</b>                    | Phone number / click-to-call button             | 'Call now: 98XXXXXXX'                             |
| <b>Location</b>                | Address and map link                            | 'Shop 5, Main Road - 1.2 km away'                 |
| <b>Structured snippet</b>      | List of features under a header                 | 'Cuisines: Gujarati, Chinese, Italian'            |
| <b>Price</b>                   | Products / services with prices                 | 'Goa package - from ₹12,999'                      |
| <b>Promotion</b>               | Special offer or sale                           | '20% off on Diwali'                               |
| <b>Image / Lead form / App</b> | Pictures, in-ad enquiry form, app download link | Dish photos; form to enquire for a tour           |

**Exam tip:** For 'any three' choose Sitelink, Callout and Call (easiest). For 'various extensions' write 6-8 from the table.

## Solved paper - Summer 2026 (12-05-2026)

### Q1(a) [3 marks] Differentiate: Traditional marketing and Digital marketing.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q1(b) (4M)

| Point                      | Traditional marketing                          | Digital marketing                                      |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Medium                     | TV, radio, newspaper, hoardings, pamphlets     | Internet: websites, search, social media, email, apps  |
| <b>Approach</b>            | One-way broadcast - same message to everybody  | Targeted and personalised message to a chosen audience |
| <b>Customer engagement</b> | Little or no direct response; feedback is slow | Two-way: likes, comments, shares, chats, instant reply |
| Cost                       | High (ad space, printing, airtime)             | Lower; start with a small budget                       |
| Reach                      | Local / limited by geography                   | Global, 24x7                                           |
| Measurement                | Difficult and slow (guess-work)                | Real-time and exact (clicks, conversions, ROI)         |
| Flexibility                | Cannot change once printed or aired            | Can edit or pause a campaign any time                  |
| Example                    | Newspaper ad of a shop                         | Instagram ad targeted to people near the shop          |

**Exam tip:** For 3 marks write the first five rows. For the 4-mark 'approach and engagement' question, explain the two bold rows in 2 lines each, then add cost and measurement.

### Q1(b) [4 marks] Explain the importance of data privacy in the context of digital marketing.

Digital marketers collect lots of **personal data** (name, phone, email, location, browsing and purchase history). **Data privacy** means collecting, storing and using this data lawfully, with the user's consent, and keeping it safe.

#### Why it is important

1. **Builds trust** and loyal customers - people share data only with brands they trust.
2. **Legal compliance** - laws like GDPR, CCPA and India's DPDP Act give heavy fines for misuse.
3. **Protects the brand** from data breaches and bad publicity.
4. **Ethical marketing** - respects people's choice (opt-in, opt-out, no spam).
5. Shapes campaigns: **first-party data**, consent-based marketing and cookie-less tracking.

| Law            | Region                | Key idea                                                                                                   |
|----------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| GDPR           | European Union (2018) | Clear consent, right to access / delete data, heavy fines                                                  |
| CCPA           | California, USA       | Users can know, delete and opt out of the sale of their data                                               |
| DPDP Act, 2023 | India                 | Consent-based processing of digital personal data; duties for data fiduciaries; rights for data principals |

Impact on campaigns: (1) collect **first-party data** directly (forms, sign-ups, loyalty); (2) move from third-party cookies to **cookie-less tracking**; (3) use **consent banners** and double opt-in emails.

### Q1(c) [7 marks] How can a business develop an effective digital marketing strategy? Explain with an appropriate example.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q2(a) OR (3M)

A **digital marketing strategy** is a plan that decides **what to achieve, for whom, through which channels, and how to measure it**. Steps:

1. **Market research and target audience:** find who the customers are (age, location, interests, needs), study competitors. Make buyer personas.
2. **Set objectives (SMART):** Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound. E.g. 'get 500 website visitors and 50 orders in 3 months'.
3. **Set the budget.**
4. **Select digital channels** (use the P.O.E.M. mix): website + SEO, social media, email, paid ads (Google / Meta).
5. **Plan content and a calendar:** blogs, posts, videos, offers, and when to publish.
6. **Execute** the campaigns using tools (Canva, Mailchimp, Meta Ads Manager).
7. **Measure and optimise:** track KPIs (traffic, CTR, conversion rate, ROI) with Google Analytics and improve.

### Example: a local bakery 'Sweet Delights'

| Step      | Action                                                                                                                               |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Audience  | Families and young adults within 10 km who order birthday cakes                                                                      |
| Objective | 100 online cake orders in 3 months                                                                                                   |
| Channels  | Website with SEO (Owned), Instagram Reels and Google Local ads (Paid), customer reviews and shares (Earned), WhatsApp / email offers |
| Content   | Reels of cake making, 'cake of the week', festival offers                                                                            |
| Measure   | Website visits, orders, Instagram reach, cost per order                                                                              |

### Q1(c) OR [7 marks] How does voice search and conversational AI optimization play in SEO today? Explain with a suitable example.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q1(a) (3M), Q2(a) (3M)

- **Voice search:** users speak to assistants (Alexa, Siri, Google Assistant) instead of typing.
- **Conversational AI:** AI systems (chatbots, AI assistants) that understand natural language and reply like a human.

### How voice queries are different

- Longer and **natural / question-type** ('where is the nearest shoe repair shop open now?') versus typed 'shoe repair'.
- Often **local** ('near me') and on mobile.
- The assistant reads **one answer** aloud - usually from the featured snippet.

### How to optimise (role in SEO)

1. Use **long-tail, conversational keywords** and question words (what, how, where, best).
2. Create **FAQ pages** and give short, direct answers (2-3 lines) to target **featured snippets / position zero**.
3. Apply **schema (structured data)** so the machine understands the content.
4. Strong **local SEO**: complete Google Business Profile with address, timings, phone.
5. Make the site **fast and mobile-friendly** and use HTTPS.
6. Write in a natural, easy-to-read tone, with clear headings.

**Example:** A pizza shop adds an FAQ 'What time does Pizza Point open?' with the short answer and its Business Profile. When someone asks Siri 'pizza places open now', the shop is more likely to be read out.

Conclusion: voice search and AI assistants reward clear, direct, local and well-structured content.

### Q2(a) [3 marks] Describe the need of SEO in digital marketing.

**SEO (Search Engine Optimization)** is the process of improving a website so that it ranks higher in the **free (organic)** results of search engines like Google.

## Need / importance

- **More organic traffic** - most people click only the top results on page 1.
- **Cost-effective** - no payment per click, long-lasting results.
- **Trust and credibility** - users trust high-ranking sites.
- **Targeted visitors** - people searching for exactly your product.
- Better **user experience** (fast, mobile-friendly site) and higher conversions.
- Helps beat competitors and supports local business (near-me searches).

## Q2(b) [4 marks] Differentiate between on-page and off-page SEO.

| Point         | On-page SEO                                                                                           | Off-page SEO                                                                                    | Technical SEO                                                                                   |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Meaning       | Optimising things <b>on</b> the website itself                                                        | Activities <b>outside</b> the website to build authority                                        | Optimising the site's <b>back-end</b> so it can be crawled and indexed                          |
| Main elements | Title tag, meta description, headings, keywords, quality content, URL, image alt text, internal links | Backlinks, guest posts, social sharing, brand mentions, directory listings, influencer outreach | Site speed, mobile-friendly, HTTPS, sitemap.xml, robots.txt, schema markup, fixing broken links |
| Control       | Fully in your control                                                                                 | Partly (depends on others)                                                                      | In your control                                                                                 |
| Goal          | Relevance                                                                                             | Authority and trust                                                                             | Crawlability and performance                                                                    |
| Example       | Adding 'custom cakes' in title tag                                                                    | Getting a link from a food blog                                                                 | Compressing images to load faster                                                               |

## Q2(c) [7 marks] How will you do off page optimization for a newly launched website? Discuss with examples.

★ **Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q1(c) (7M), Q1(c) OR (7M), Q2(c) OR (7M)**

**Off-page SEO** = actions taken **outside** your website to raise its authority, trust and ranking. For a new website (no authority yet):

| Activity                        | How to do it                                                    | Example                                              |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Quality backlinks               | Earn links from relevant, trusted sites                         | A new fitness website gets a link from a health blog |
| Guest blogging                  | Write useful articles on other blogs with a link back           | Guest post on a popular fitness blog                 |
| Social media promotion          | Share content, build a following, drive traffic                 | Post articles on Instagram, LinkedIn, X, Facebook    |
| Business directories / listings | Submit to directories and Google Business Profile with same NAP | Justdial, Google Maps                                |
| Influencer and PR outreach      | Collaborate with influencers; press release for launch          | Local news site covers the launch                    |
| Community engagement            | Answer questions on Quora / Reddit / forums with helpful links  | Quora answer with a link to your guide               |
| Reviews and brand mentions      | Ask customers for reviews; get brand talked about               | Google reviews, testimonials                         |
| Video / content sharing         | Upload videos, infographics, slides                             | YouTube video linking to your site                   |

- Focus on **quality over quantity**; avoid link farms and paid links (black hat).
- Analyse competitors' backlinks with free tools such as **openlinkprofiler.org**.
- Measure with domain authority, number of referring domains and referral traffic.

## Q2(a) OR [3 marks] Express the role of social media in digital marketing.

- **Brand awareness:** reaches millions of users quickly.
- **Engagement:** two-way contact through likes, comments, shares and messages.
- **Traffic and leads:** drives visitors to the website, lead forms.
- **Customer service and feedback** in real time.
- **Targeted advertising** using age, interest, location.
- **Insights:** analytics show what content works.

## Q2(b) OR [4 marks] Explain how search engine algorithms work and how they rank websites.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q2(c) (7M)



- **Crawling:** automated programs called **crawlers / spiders / bots** (Googlebot) travel from link to link and discover new or updated pages. A **sitemap.xml** helps them; **robots.txt** tells them what not to crawl.
- **Indexing:** the content of each page (text, images, titles, links) is analysed and saved in a huge database called the **index**.
- **Ranking:** when a user searches, the **algorithm** picks relevant pages from the index and orders them using hundreds of signals. Best results are shown first on the **SERP** (search engine results page).

### Key factors that influence ranking

| Factor                        | Why it matters                                                              |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Content quality and relevance | Useful, original content that matches the user's search intent ranks higher |
| Keywords                      | Right keywords in title, headings and body show what the page is about      |
| Backlinks                     | Links from trusted sites act as 'votes' of trust (authority)                |
| Mobile-friendliness           | Google uses mobile-first indexing                                           |
| Page speed                    | Slow pages lose visitors and rank lower                                     |
| HTTPS security                | Secure sites are preferred                                                  |
| User experience               | Low bounce rate, easy navigation, longer time on site                       |
| Freshness and structured data | Regularly updated pages; schema helps rich results                          |
| Location and personalisation  | Results change by user's location and search history                        |

**Exam tip:** 4 marks: write the 4-step flow with 1 line each and 4-5 factors. 7 marks: full answer with the table.

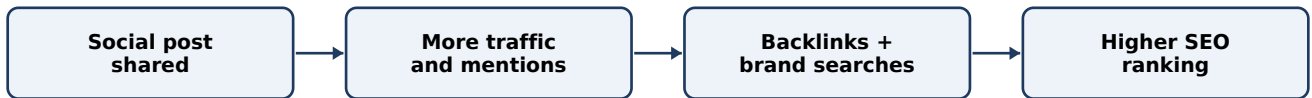
## Q2(c) OR [7 marks] How can social media improve SEO rankings? Explain with a suitable example.

Google says social media signals (likes, shares) are **not a direct ranking factor**, but social media **helps SEO indirectly**:

1. **More traffic and visibility:** shared content gets more visitors, which can lead to more engagement and links.
2. **Backlinks:** content that goes viral is picked up by bloggers and websites who link to it - strong ranking signal.
3. **Brand awareness and brand searches:** more people search for your brand name, which signals popularity and authority.

4. **Faster content discovery:** new posts shared on social media are found and crawled sooner.
5. **Social profiles rank** in search results and take more space on the first page for your brand name.
6. **Local SEO:** reviews and location tags support local ranking.
7. **Content distribution and audience insight:** see which topics people like and write SEO content on them.

**Example:** A bakery posts a Reel of a new cake and shares the blog link. The post goes viral, a food blogger links to the blog, many people search 'Sweet Delights cakes', and the website ranks higher for related keywords.



### Q3(a) [3 marks] Explain any one Single-touch attribution model with example.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q3(c) OR (7M)

**Attribution model:** a rule that decides **which marketing touchpoint gets credit** for a conversion. **Single-touch** models give 100% credit to just one touchpoint.

- **First-touch (first-click):** all credit goes to the **first** interaction that introduced the customer.
- **Last-touch (last-click):** all credit goes to the **last** interaction before the conversion.

**Example (last-click):** A customer sees an Instagram ad → reads an email → searches the brand on Google and clicks a search ad → buys a ₹1,000 product. Under last-click, the **Google search ad gets full ₹1,000 credit**; Instagram and email get 0. Under first-touch the Instagram ad would get it.

Weakness: ignores all other touchpoints.

### Q3(b) [4 marks] Explain black hat and white hat SEO techniques.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q2(b) (4M)

| Point      | White Hat SEO                                                                                                              | Black Hat SEO                                                                                            |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Meaning    | Ethical techniques that follow search-engine guidelines                                                                    | Unethical tricks that try to fool search engines for fast ranking                                        |
| Focus      | Real users and quality content                                                                                             | Only search-engine algorithm                                                                             |
| Techniques | Quality content, proper keyword research, good titles and meta tags, mobile-friendly site, genuine backlinks, fast loading | Keyword stuffing, cloaking, hidden text, link farms / buying links, doorway pages, copied / spun content |
| Result     | Slow but long-term, stable ranking                                                                                         | Quick gain but short-lived                                                                               |
| Risk       | Very low                                                                                                                   | Penalty or complete removal (ban) from search results                                                    |
| Example    | A travel blog writes original guides and gets links from other travel sites                                                | A site repeats 'cheap shoes cheap shoes cheap shoes' 100 times or hides white text on a white background |

Grey hat SEO lies in between (not clearly breaking rules).

### Q3(c) [7 marks] Explain A/B and multivariate testing tools and their role in optimizing website performance.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q3(c) (7M)

- **A/B testing (split testing):** two versions of a page / element - **A (control)** and **B (variation)** - are shown to **different random groups** of visitors at the same time. The version with the better result (more clicks, sign-ups, sales) wins. Only **one element** is changed (e.g. button

colour or headline).

- **Multivariate testing (MVT):** tests **several elements together** and all their **combinations** to find the best combination.



| Point             | A/B testing                         | Multivariate testing                                  |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| What is tested    | One variable, two (or few) versions | Multiple variables and their combinations             |
| Example           | Headline 1 vs Headline 2            | 2 headlines × 2 images × 2 buttons = 8 combinations   |
| Traffic needed    | Less                                | Much more (traffic is divided among all combinations) |
| Time / complexity | Simple and fast                     | Complex, longer                                       |
| Result            | Which version is better             | Which combination, and how elements interact          |
| Best for          | Big changes, low-traffic sites      | Fine-tuning high-traffic pages                        |

### Testing tools and their role in optimising website performance

- **Tools:** Optimizely, VWO (Visual Website Optimizer), AB Tasty, Adobe Target, Convert (Google Optimize was shut down in 2023).
- **Role:** split traffic randomly, show variations, track goals, calculate **statistical significance** and show the winner.
- **Benefits:** increases **conversion rate**, decisions based on data not guesses, lowers risk of bad changes, improves user experience and ROI.

### Q3(a) OR [3 marks] Define the terms: Unique visitors, Average Visit Duration, Bounce rate.

#### ★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q3(a) (3M), Q3(a) OR (3M)

*How much to write: Write the definitions of unique visitors, average visit duration and bounce rate (three short definitions with formula).*

- **Unique visitors:** the number of **different individual people (or devices)** who visit a website in a given period. Each person is counted **only once**, even if he visits 10 times (identified by cookie / device ID).
- **Why it matters:** shows the real size of the audience and reach of the site, unlike total visits.

*Example:* Ravi visits your site 5 times and Meena 2 times in a week → **visits = 7, unique visitors = 2.**

**Pageviews** (related): total number of pages viewed; one page opened again is counted again.

- **Average Visit Duration:** the average time a visitor spends on the site in one visit. Longer time usually means interesting content.

**Formula:** Avg visit duration = Total time spent by all visits ÷ Number of visits. Example: 6,000 sec ÷ 100 visits = 60 sec.

- **Bounce rate:** the percentage of visits in which the visitor **leaves after viewing only one page** without any interaction. High bounce rate = page is not relevant, slow or confusing.

**Formula:** Bounce rate = (Single-page visits ÷ Total visits) × 100. Example: 40 of 100 visits leave from the first page → **40%.**

Note: in GA4, bounce rate is the opposite of 'engagement rate' (sessions that were not engaged).

### Q3(b) OR [4 marks] Describe the strategies for building backlinks.

A **backlink** is a link from another website to yours. Search engines treat quality backlinks as votes of trust. Strategies:

1. **Create link-worthy content:** original research, infographics, guides, free tools.
2. **Guest blogging:** write for related websites and include a link.
3. **Broken-link building:** find broken links on other sites and suggest your page as replacement.
4. **Outreach and influencers:** ask bloggers, journalists and partners to mention you.
5. **Directory and local listings** and social profiles.
6. **Competitor backlink analysis** to find where competitors get links (openlinkprofiler.org, Ahrefs).
7. **Press releases and PR** for news-worthy events.

Avoid buying links or link farms (black hat) - they can lead to penalties.

### Q3(c) OR [7 marks] With a suitable example, explain how businesses can set up goals in Google Analytics.

★ **Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q4(a) (3M)**

A **goal** measures how often visitors complete a valuable action. Setting goals lets you calculate the **conversion rate**. (In GA4 the older 'goals' are set up as **events marked as key events / conversions**; menu names may differ slightly by version.)

#### Common goal types

| Goal type                   | Meaning                              | Example                                         |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Destination                 | Visitor reaches a specific page      | 'Thank you' page after order (/thank-you)       |
| Duration                    | Session lasts longer than a set time | Visit longer than 3 minutes                     |
| Pages / screens per session | Visitor views at least N pages       | Views 5 or more pages                           |
| Event                       | A specific action happens            | Click on 'Add to cart', video play, form submit |

#### Steps (example: online cake shop wants to measure orders)

1. Connect the website to **Google Analytics** (tag directly or through GTM).
2. Open **Admin** → Events (or Goals) and choose **create new goal / event**.
3. Select the type - e.g. **Destination** goal with page */order-confirmation* (or an event 'purchase').
4. Give it a name ('Cake order'), optionally a **value** (e.g. ₹800) and a funnel (cart → checkout → confirmation).
5. Save / mark the event as a key event (conversion) and **test** it.
6. View **goal / conversion reports**: number of conversions, **conversion rate**, source that brought them.

**Result:** If 40 of 1,000 visitors reach the confirmation page, conversion rate = 4%; the report also shows whether Instagram or Google gives more orders.

### Q4(a) [3 marks] Define Analytics and list out SEO analytics tools.

**Web analytics:** the collection, measurement, analysis and reporting of website data (visitors, pages, sources, conversions) to understand user behaviour and improve the website and marketing.

#### SEO analytics tools

- **Google Search Console** - clicks, impressions, ranking queries, indexing errors.
- **Google Analytics** - organic traffic and behaviour.

- **Ahrefs, SEMrush, Moz** - keywords, backlinks, rank tracking.
- **Ubersuggest, SEOptimer, Sitechecker** - audits and keyword ideas.
- Google PageSpeed Insights / GTmetrix - speed.

### Types of web analytics tools (syllabus 3.2)

| Type                         | Purpose / example                         |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Content analytics            | Which pages / content perform best        |
| Customer analytics           | Who the customers are and how they behave |
| Usability (UX) analytics     | Heatmaps, session recordings - Hotjar     |
| A/B and multivariate testing | Compare versions - Optimizely, VWO        |
| SEO analytics                | Search Console, Ahrefs, SEMrush           |
| General enterprise analytics | Google Analytics, Adobe Analytics         |
| Open-source analytics        | Matomo, Open Web Analytics                |
| Product analytics            | In-app behaviour - Mixpanel, Amplitude    |

### Q4(b) [4 marks] For a fashion retail store's Instagram account, discuss three Instagram Insights metrics essential for monitoring content strategy.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q4(b) (4M)

**Insights** (in **Meta Business Suite** / Instagram professional dashboard) show how content and audience perform. Three essential metrics for a fashion retail store:

1. **Reach and impressions:** number of unique accounts that saw the post (reach) and total views (impressions) - shows brand visibility of new collections.
2. **Engagement (likes, comments, shares, saves):** shows which posts / Reels people like. High **saves and shares** = interested in the product.
3. **Profile visits and website / link clicks:** shows interest and traffic leading to the online store - closer to sales.

Also useful: follower growth, audience demographics (age, gender, city), best times to post, Reels watch time. Use them to repeat what works.

### Q4(c) [7 marks] Explain the concept of Dynamic Ads and give an example of how they can be personalized to engage the LinkedIn audience.

**Dynamic ads** are ads whose content is **generated and personalised automatically** for each viewer using data (profile details, browsing behaviour, product catalogue). One ad template shows **different text / images to different people**.

#### Key points

- Created from a **template + data feed**, so thousands of variations are made automatically.
- Saves time and gives **higher relevance, CTR and conversions**.
- Common on Meta (catalogue ads that show products you viewed), Google and LinkedIn.

#### LinkedIn dynamic ads

LinkedIn dynamic ads personalise the creative with the viewer's **LinkedIn profile data** - such as **name, profile photo, job title, company** - in a professional audience. (Formats include follower ads, spotlight ads and content / job ads.)

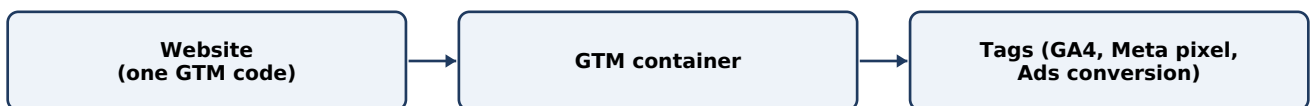
**Example:** A software-training company runs an ad: *'Hi Priya, upskill as a Data Analyst - Python course for professionals at Infosys. Enroll now'*, showing her name, photo and company. A different viewer sees his own name and company. Another example: a job-ad that shows *'Jobs at [Company] matching your skills'*.

**Benefits:** personal feel → more attention, better engagement, better leads; no manual work for each audience.

**Q4(a) OR [3 marks] Define Google Tag Manager and list out tasks of Google Tag Manager.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q3(b) OR (4M)

**Google Tag Manager (GTM)** is a **free tag-management system** by Google. You place **one GTM container code** on the website, and then add, edit and manage all **tags** (small tracking code snippets such as Google Analytics, Meta pixel, conversion tracking) from a web dashboard **without changing the website code** each time.



**Main parts**

- **Tag:** code that sends data to a tool.
- **Trigger:** the rule when the tag fires (page view, button click, form submit).
- **Variable:** values used by tags / triggers (page URL, click text).

**Tasks of GTM / how it simplifies analytics setup**

- Add and update tracking tags **without a developer**.
- Track clicks, form submissions, scroll, video views, downloads (event tracking).
- Manage many tags in **one place** - faster page loading than many separate scripts.
- **Preview / debug mode** to test before publishing, with **version control** and rollback.
- Set up conversion tracking for ads and remarketing.

**Q4(b) OR [4 marks] Explain different methods of data collection in website analytics.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q3(b) (4M)

Two main methods are used to collect website visitor data:

| Point         | Weblogs (server log files)                                                                                                | Page tagging (JavaScript tags)                                                                                         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| How it works  | Web server automatically records <b>every request</b> in a log file (IP, date/time, page, status code, browser, referrer) | A small <b>JavaScript code (tag)</b> on each page runs in the visitor's browser and sends data to the analytics server |
| Data location | On your own server                                                                                                        | On the analytics vendor's server (e.g. Google Analytics)                                                               |
| Setup         | No code needed on pages; needs log analyser software                                                                      | Add tag to every page (or use Google Tag Manager)                                                                      |
| Tracks        | Page requests, bots and crawlers, errors (404)                                                                            | User behaviour: clicks, scrolls, events, time on page, device, real-time                                               |
| Limitations   | Cannot track JavaScript events; cached pages and bots confuse counts; hard to identify unique visitors                    | Fails if JavaScript is disabled or blocked (ad-blockers); depends on third party                                       |
| Example       | Apache / IIS log analysis                                                                                                 | Google Analytics, Matomo                                                                                               |

Other methods: cookies (identify returning visitors), packet sniffing, and in-app SDKs for mobile apps.

**Q4(c) OR [7 marks] Describe the main functions of a Facebook Page, Business Manager, and Facebook Ads. How can these assets help businesses?**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q4(b) (4M)

| Asset                                             | Main functions                                                                                                                                                                       | How it helps the business                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Facebook Page</b>                              | Public business profile: posts, photos, videos, about info, contact, reviews and ratings, messages (Messenger), shop / call-to-action button, events                                 | Online identity, builds community and trust, direct customer communication and support, free organic reach |
| <b>Business Manager</b> (now Meta Business Suite) | One central place to manage <b>Pages, ad accounts, Instagram accounts, pixels</b> ; give roles and permissions to team / agencies; billing; insights; schedule posts                 | Safe, organised control of all assets; many people can work without sharing passwords; combined reporting  |
| <b>Facebook Ads</b> (Ads Manager)                 | Create campaigns with objective (awareness, traffic, leads, sales), <b>targeting</b> (age, location, interests), budget, placements (Facebook, Instagram), ad formats; track results | Reaches the exact audience, quick customers / leads, measurable ROI, retargeting                           |

**Together:** the Page builds presence → Business Manager organises and secures it → Ads Manager promotes it and measures results. *Example:* a local bakery builds a Page with menu and reviews, adds the team in Business Manager, and runs a ₹200/day ad for 'birthday cakes' to people within 10 km.

### Q5(a) [3 marks] What is e-mail marketing? List different types of e-mail marketing.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q5(a) (3M), Q5(b) (4M)

**Email marketing:** sending commercial messages (offers, news, updates) by email to a list of subscribers to promote products, build relationships and increase sales. It is cheap, direct, personal and measurable.

#### Types of marketing emails

- **Promotional emails** - offers, discounts, sales, new-product launches.
- **Transactional emails** - triggered by a user action: order confirmation, invoice, shipping update, password reset.
- **Newsletter / informational** - regular updates, tips, blog posts.
- **Welcome emails** - sent after sign-up.
- **Abandoned-cart emails** - remind about items left in cart.
- **Re-engagement / feedback / seasonal** emails.

| Point      | Promotional email                                         | Transactional email                                    |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Purpose    | To sell / promote                                         | To give information about a user's action              |
| Trigger    | Sent by the company to many people (campaign)             | Automatic, after the user's action                     |
| Permission | Needs subscriber's consent (opt-in); has unsubscribe link | Sent even without marketing opt-in                     |
| Open rate  | Lower                                                     | Very high (people expect it)                           |
| Example    | 'Flat 20% off on cakes this weekend'                      | 'Your order #1234 is confirmed' / OTP / password reset |

### Q5(b) [4 marks] Explain the concept of Twitter Marketing.

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q4(a) OR (3M)

**Twitter (X) marketing** means using the microblogging platform X (formerly Twitter; 'tweets' are now called posts) to promote a brand through short messages, conversations and ads, mainly for **real-time engagement**.

- **Hashtags (#):** group posts by topic, increase reach and join trends / campaigns. Use 1-2 relevant hashtags.
- **Customer service:** reply to complaints and questions publicly or by DM - quick response builds trust.
- **Live tweets:** share live updates from events, launches, Q&A sessions.
- **Content:** news, offers, polls, images, short videos; engage by replying and retweeting.
- **Advertising:** promoted tweets, promoted accounts, promoted trends.
- **Analytics** to track impressions, engagement, followers.

**Q5(c) [7 marks] Outline the various ad extensions offered by Google Ads and provide an example of each.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q5(c) OR (7M)

**Ad extensions** (now also called 'assets') are **extra pieces of information** added to a Google text ad (beyond headline and description) to make it bigger and more useful. They are free to add - you pay only the normal click cost.

**Importance**

- Make the ad **larger and more visible** on the results page.
- Give more information (phone, location, links) → **higher CTR** (often 10-15% more).
- Improve **Ad Rank and Quality Score**, which can lower cost per click.
- Let customers act directly (call, visit, enquire) → more conversions.

| Extension                      | What it shows                                   | Example (a restaurant / travel agency)            |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sitelink</b>                | Extra links to other pages of the site          | 'Menu', 'Book a table', 'Offers'                  |
| <b>Callout</b>                 | Short text highlighting benefits                | 'Free delivery', '24x7 support', 'No booking fee' |
| <b>Call</b>                    | Phone number / click-to-call button             | 'Call now: 98XXXXXXX'                             |
| <b>Location</b>                | Address and map link                            | 'Shop 5, Main Road - 1.2 km away'                 |
| <b>Structured snippet</b>      | List of features under a header                 | 'Cuisines: Gujarati, Chinese, Italian'            |
| <b>Price</b>                   | Products / services with prices                 | 'Goa package - from ₹12,999'                      |
| <b>Promotion</b>               | Special offer or sale                           | '20% off on Diwali'                               |
| <b>Image / Lead form / App</b> | Pictures, in-ad enquiry form, app download link | Dish photos; form to enquire for a tour           |

**Exam tip:** For 'any three' choose Sitelink, Callout and Call (easiest). For 'various extensions' write 6-8 from the table.

**Q5(a) OR [3 marks] Define: Search Ads, Display Ads, Shopping Ads.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q5(c) (7M), Q5(a) OR (3M), Q5(b) OR (4M)

- **Search ads:** text ads shown on **search results pages** above / below organic results when a user searches a matching keyword.
- **Display ads:** image / banner ads shown on **websites, apps and YouTube** in the Google Display Network - good for awareness and remarketing.
- **Shopping ads:** product listing ads showing **product image, price and store name** in search results - for online stores (uses Google Merchant Center).

Other campaign types (syllabus): paid video ads (YouTube), local service ads, app ads, social media ads.

**Q5(b) OR [4 marks] Imagine you are starting a new business in the fashion industry. Develop a social media marketing strategy outline (platforms, content ideas, engagement tactics).**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q4(c) OR (7M)

- **Platforms:** **Instagram** (Reels, Stories, shopping tags) for visuals and young buyers; **Pinterest** for inspiration and traffic; **Facebook** for ads and community; **YouTube Shorts** for styling videos.
- **Content ideas:** new-collection reels, 'style one outfit 3 ways', behind-the-scenes of design, customer photos (UGC), festival lookbooks, short reviews and sale announcements.
- **Engagement tactics:** reply to comments and DMs, polls and quizzes in Stories, giveaways, influencer collaborations, hashtag campaign, live Q&A with the designer.
- **Paid and measure:** Meta ads (carousel / lead ads) to target audience; use Insights to track reach, engagement and sales.

**Q5(c) OR [7 marks] Discuss the concept of Quality Score with suitable example in Google AdWords and its impact on ad rankings.**

★ Repeated topic - also asked in Winter 2025: Q5(c) (7M), Q5(a) OR (3M), Q5(b) OR (4M)

**Quality Score** is Google's **rating from 1 to 10** (10 = best) of the quality and relevance of your **keyword, ad and landing page**. Higher score = better and cheaper placement.

### Three components

1. **Expected click-through rate (CTR):** how likely people are to click your ad for that keyword.
2. **Ad relevance:** how closely the ad text matches what the user searched.
3. **Landing page experience:** relevant, useful, fast, mobile-friendly page with clear content.

### Impact on ad ranking and cost

**Formula:**  $\text{Ad Rank} \approx \text{Bid} \times \text{Quality Score}$  (Google also considers ad extensions and context). Actual  $\text{CPC} \approx (\text{Ad Rank of the ad below} \div \text{your Quality Score}) + ₹0.01$ .

- Higher Quality Score → **higher Ad Rank** → better position, even with a lower bid.
- Higher Quality Score → **lower cost per click** and more impressions.

### Example

|                    | Advertiser A   | Advertiser B                                   |
|--------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Max bid            | ₹10            | ₹6                                             |
| Quality Score      | 4              | 9                                              |
| Ad Rank (Bid × QS) | 40             | 54                                             |
| Result             | Lower position | <b>Higher position and pays less per click</b> |

B wins the better position although its bid is lower. **How to improve:** use tightly grouped keywords, write ad text with the keyword, improve landing page speed and relevance, add ad extensions.